LANGO APP

Won Nyaci me Lango

CONCEPT PAPER FOR PARTNERS AND DONORS
2026

A PLATFORM FOR UGANDA'S CULTURES

Every tribe. Every voice. One platform.

A mobile home for culture. It preserves language and heritage, connects people of the same clan and community, and builds the community-owned data that teaches AI to speak our languages.

- Tested first with Lango
- Built for every community in Uganda
- Works offline



Testing edition: Lango. Every screen in this paper is the real app, running on real Lango content.

Kakebe Technologies Limited
Lira City, Uganda · www.kakebe.tech

01 · WHY THIS, WHY NOW

Culture lives in people, and most of it was never written down.

Uganda has more than 50 indigenous communities and around 40 living languages. Their proverbs, clans, histories and songs are carried in memory and spoken from one generation to the next, and that chain is under strain.

Knowledge is oral and fragile

Languages, clans and stories are held by elders. When one passes, a library closes, and little of it is recorded or searchable.

Young people and the diaspora are far from home

Many have no easy way to learn the language, find their clan or hear the stories their grandparents know.

Our languages are missing from AI

Most Ugandan languages have almost no digital text or speech data, so translators, voice assistants and learning tools do not work in them.

Institutions lack the tools

Cultural institutions hold the mandate and the trust of their people, but not the software to gather, check and share what the community knows.

OUR ANSWER

One app that every community can own.

Lango App puts a community's dictionary, clans, heritage, history, radio, podcast and Bible in one phone app and lets its people add what they know. Its own language experts review every entry.

- **Preserves** language, clans, history and oral tradition
- **Collects** words, proverbs, stories, audio and photos from the community
- **Connects** people of the same clan and culture, at home and abroad
- **Teaches** the next generation, a few minutes a day
- **Feeds AI** with consented, expert-checked language data



THE LANGO TESTING EDITION TODAY

2,829 dictionary entries, queued for expert verification

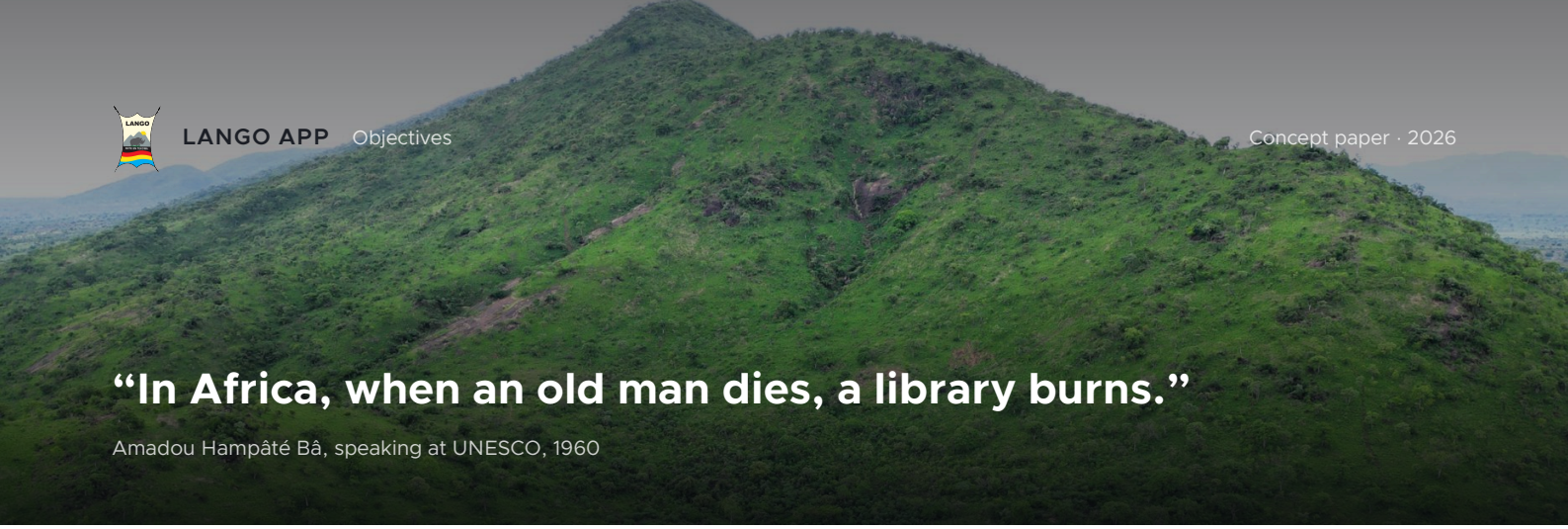
149 Lango clans to document (5 verified so far)

10 districts mapped, including Lira City

10 heritage items: dances, ceremonies, sites

1,524 app phrases ready for translation into Leb Lango

Figures from the running Lango testing edition. Community figures are approximate.



> “In Africa, when an old man dies, a library burns.”
>
> Amadou Hampâté Bâ, speaking at UNESCO, 1960

02 · OBJECTIVES

Why we are building it: seven objectives

1 Preserve

Document language, clans, history and oral tradition before they are lost, in the community's own words.

Measure: entries documented and verified, hours of audio recorded

2 Collect

Turn everyday knowledge into structured, reviewed data: words, proverbs, stories, audio, photos and places.

Measure: contributions received, reviewed and published

3 Power AI

Build consented, expert-verified text and speech datasets so translation, speech recognition and voice tools can serve Ugandan languages.

Measure: hours of verified speech, size of parallel text

4 Connect

Bring people of the same culture, clan and heritage together, in the village, in town and across the diaspora.

Measure: members in clan groups, messages exchanged

5 Teach

Give young people a daily habit of learning their language: dictionary, quizzes, weekly challenges and streaks.

Measure: daily learners, streaks, challenge scores

6 Empower institutions

Give every cultural institution its own edition, its own admin tools and ownership of its data.

Measure: editions launched, editors trained

7 Sustain

Create lasting funding and partnerships (gifts, programs, research collaboration) so that the work continues long after the first launch and every edition can look after itself.

Measure: partners engaged, recurring gifts, editions that fund their own running costs

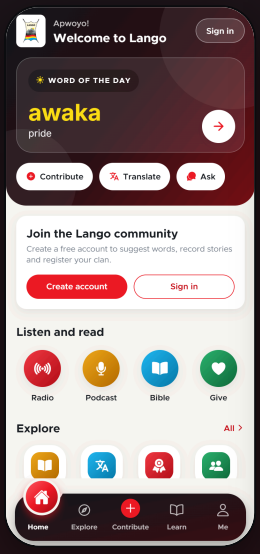
WHO IT SERVES

- Elders and custodians
- Youth and students
- The diaspora
- Clans and families
- Cultural institutions
- Researchers and AI builders

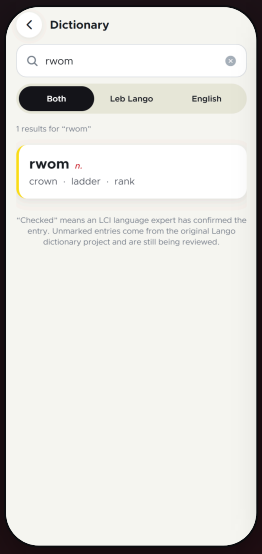
03 · WHAT HAS BEEN BUILT

A complete culture app, already working.

The Lango testing edition is a full Android app. These are real screens, not mock-ups.



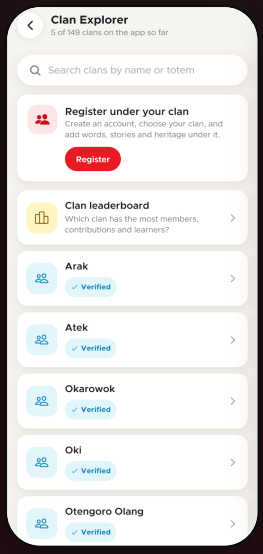
Home
Word of the day, shortcuts



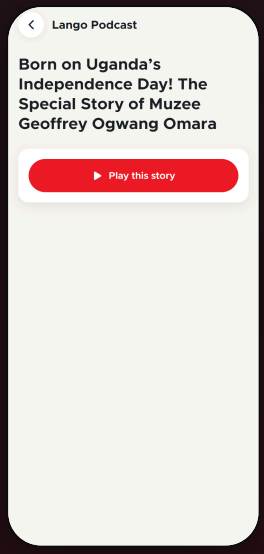
Dictionary
Leb Lango and English



Proverbs
With meanings



Clan Explorer
Verified clans



Podcast
Elders' stories

Learn

A dictionary of 2,829 entries that works offline, an AI translator, proverbs, a phrasebook and a daily word quiz.

Explore

Clan Explorer, districts and Lira City, heritage, history, notable people, events and news.

Contribute

Add words, proverbs, oral stories, nature records, documents and heritage sites with photo, audio or video. Works offline; every entry is reviewed.

Connect

Clan groups: see who is in yours, write to each other, browse the clan archive. Streaks, weekly challenges and leaderboards keep people coming back.

Listen and read

Langо Radio, a podcast of elders' stories and the Lango Bible, with a player that keeps going when the screen is off.

Support

Give to the institution or to keeping the app running, back programs, and see transparency figures.

Android first · Offline dictionary and queued contributions · English and local-language interface · Expert review before publication

04 · DATA AND AI

From a phone in the village to data that teaches AI.

Every word, proverb and story added to the app can become part of a clean, consented, expert-checked dataset that belongs to the community. That is what low-resource language AI is missing.



WHAT THE DATA CAN POWER

Machine translation

Local language to English and back, from verified word and sentence pairs.

Speech recognition

Voice to text for languages that today have almost no recordings.

Text to speech

Natural voices for learning, radio and accessibility.

Assistants and learning tools

Chat, search and teaching tools that answer in the community's own language.

Responsible by design

- **Consent first.** Each contribution carries the contributor's choice: keep ownership, share openly with credit, or give it to the institution.
- **Experts in the loop.** Nothing is published, or used as data, before the community's language experts review it.
- **Community ownership.** Each institution governs its own data and decides who may use it.
- **Privacy.** Names show as first name and initial, and members can delete their account.

TODAY

A dictionary-based translator and assistant that answer from the verified archive, plus the contribution and review workflow that produces the data.

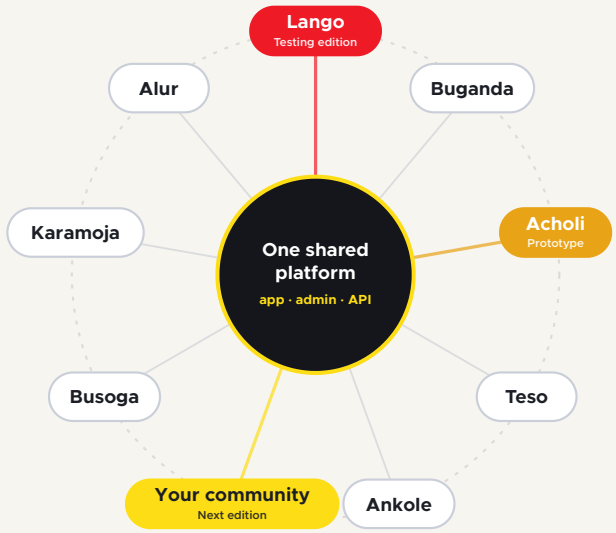
NEXT, WITH RESEARCH PARTNERS

Train and evaluate translation and speech models on the verified data, and return them to the app and to the community.

05 · BEYOND LANGO

Built for Lango. Ready for every community in Uganda.

Lango is where we test and prove the idea. The platform is designed so that Buganda, Acholi, Teso, Ankole and every other community can have its own edition: its own name, language, clans and content, on shared technology.



Examples of communities the platform is built to serve. A prototype Acholi edition has already been built from the same code base.

Shared by every edition

- The app, admin panel and API
- Contribution, review and verification workflow
- Dictionary, translator, quizzes, clan groups
- Radio, podcast and Bible player
- The AI data pipeline and its safeguards

Owned by each community

- Name, logo and colours
- Language, and the experts who verify it
- Clan or chiefdom register, districts, history
- All content and all data it collects
- Its administrators and its institution's voice

HOW A NEW EDITION LAUNCHES

1. Partner
A cultural institution or foundation sponsors its edition

2. Configure
Name, colours, language, clans and districts

3. Fill and verify
Seed content, train editors, start expert review

4. Launch
Release on Android with the community

PROPOSED ROADMAP

NOW
Lango testing edition
Build 4 in the hands of testers. Field feedback with the Lango institution.

FIRST 6 MONTHS
Lango public launch
Live website, store release, expert verification, first elders' stories.

6 TO 18 MONTHS
More editions
Two or three new communities. Shared datasets. First model evaluations.

BEYOND
A national network
Every community, one platform, with research partners across Uganda.



06 · PARTNER WITH US

Help every Ugandan community keep its voice.

Lango App turns a phone into a place where a culture is kept, shared and taught. We are looking for partners to take it from a tested edition to a national platform.

Founding partner

Fund the Lango launch and the next community editions, hosting and security.

Language and AI research partner

Co-design the datasets, train and evaluate models, publish results.

Community and media partner

Record elders, bring in schools, radio stations and clan associations.

Technology partner

Cloud hosting, mobile data, devices, payments and push messaging.

Cultural institutions

Sponsor your own edition and become part of the national network.

Diaspora and advocates

Champion the app abroad, give, and connect your clan to home.

Proposed pilot targets: first 12 months, Lango

- Verify all **2,829** dictionary entries with language experts
- Document and verify the **149** Lango clans
- Record and publish the first **100** elders' stories as audio
- Translate the whole app (**1,524** phrases) into Leb Lango
- Reach **5,000** members across all ten districts
- Launch a **second community edition**

Targets are proposals, to be agreed with partners.

What support makes possible

- Recording teams and expert verification in the community
- Hosting, security and offline reach for rural users
- New community editions, launched with their institutions
- Open, consented datasets and AI research in Ugandan languages
- Training for editors, teachers and youth ambassadors

Let us talk.

A detailed work plan and financial proposal are available on request.

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